SCR 1 *(6C ★)* — Sky now feels full of possibility + evidence.

8. B *(5G ★)* — Fungi play a hidden, vital role.

9. B *(2B ★)* — Mycelium = web of tiny threads in soil.

10. A *(9B ○)* — Function (recycling) and its result.

11. B *(9A ★)* — Purpose: inform about fungi.

12. B *(6C ★)* — "connect to the roots of trees, trading nutrients."

13. B *(5F ★)* — Without fungi, dead material would pile up.

14. B *(6D ★)* — Summary: network + recycling.

SCR 2 *(6C ★)* — One way fungi help + evidence.

15. B *(8E ★)* — Claim: build more protected bike lanes.

16. B *(5G ★)* — Text B provides supporting data.

17. B *(5H ★)* — Both: bike lanes benefit safety and communities.

18. B *(6B ★)* — "40% fewer injuries" only in Text B.

19. B *(9A ★)* — Text A argues for bike lanes.

20. B *(9C ○)* — Text B adds facts/numbers as evidence.

21. B *(10C ★)* — "think several moves ahead" develops it.

22. B *(10B·i ★)* — "In addition" adds a reason.

23. B *(10C ★)* — One combined sentence.

24. A *(10B ★)* — Sentence 1 is the thesis.

25. A *(10D ○)* — "and me" → "and I."

26. A *(10D·i ★)* — *band* singular → "was."

27. D *(10D ○)* — Sentence 3 is already correct — no change.

28. A *(10D·vii ★)* — "hole" → "whole."

ECR *(11B ★)* — Rubric-scored.

Short Constructed Response — Scored Samples

Real-style responses on the **2-point** rubric. Remember: a 2-point answer = **Answer + Evidence + Explanation.**

Prompt (RLA Test 1, SCR 1)

How does Maya change from the beginning to the end of the passage? Use evidence from the text.

Score 2 — Full credit. "At the start, Maya is afraid and almost quits—she 'almost reached for her bag, ready to leave.' By the end, she has faced her fear and feels proud: 'She was smiling,' and she 'played anyway.' Maya changes from fearful to confident." *— clear answer, two pieces of evidence, explanation.*

Score 1 — Partial. "Maya was scared, but then she played the piano and felt better at the end." *— correct idea, but no text evidence.*

Score 0 — No credit. "I think Maya is a good piano player, and I like music too." *— does not answer the question; no evidence.*

Prompt (RLA Test 4, SCR 2)

Explain one way fungi help a forest. Use evidence from the passage.

Score 2 — Full credit. "Fungi help a forest by feeding trees. The text says the threads 'connect to the roots of trees, trading nutrients for sugar.' This means fungi give trees nutrients they need to grow." *— answer + quotation + explanation.*

Score 1 — Partial. "Fungi help trees grow in the forest." *— correct point, but no evidence.*

Score 0 — No credit. "Mushrooms can be food for people." *— off-topic.*

> **Self-check for every SCR:** Did I (1) answer the exact question, (2) include a specific detail or quotation, and (3) explain how it supports my answer? All three yes → a 2-point response.

Extended Constructed Response — Scored Samples

One ECR prompt answered at three levels. The **10-point** rubric rewards a clear claim, coherent organization, specific explained evidence, and correct conventions.

Prompt (RLA Test 1, ECR)

Should your community start an urban beekeeping or rooftop-garden program? Write an argumentative essay using evidence from "Cities Buzz Again."

Score 8–10 — High

> Cities should start urban beekeeping and rooftop-garden programs because they make communities healthier, greener, and more connected.
>
> First, bees and gardens improve the environment. According to "Cities Buzz Again," a single hive "can pollinate millions of flowers in a day," leading to "healthier parks, gardens, and street trees." Greener neighborhoods mean cleaner air for everyone.
>
> Second, these programs bring people together. The passage explains that "neighbors who tend a shared hive learn about nature and work together," and local honey "supports small businesses." A community that grows together grows stronger.
>
> Some people worry that beekeeping is dangerous or difficult. It is true that "beekeeping takes training." However, with proper instruction, hives are safe, and schools already use them to teach science. The benefits clearly outweigh the risks.
>
> For these reasons, my community should start an urban beekeeping or rooftop-garden program. It would make our city healthier, greener, and more united.

Why it scores high: clear claim; two organized body paragraphs with explained passage evidence; a counter-argument that is answered; a strong conclusion; correct conventions.

Score 4–7 — Middle

"I think cities should have bees because they help plants. The article says bees pollinate flowers, and that is good for gardens. Also, honey is nice to have. Some people don't like bees, but they are okay. Cities should try beekeeping." *— a position and one piece of evidence, but thin development, weak organization, vague counter-argument.*

Score 1–3 — Low

"Bees are good. I like gardens. Cities should do it because honey is sweet." *— a position but no real evidence, no organization, little development.*

Planning pays off. Jot your claim and two reasons with evidence before writing. An organized essay with explained evidence almost always scores higher than a longer, unplanned one. Leave a minute to check spelling and punctuation.